Lena Varga-Holm

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data engineer with experience building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses across logistics and payments. Works across Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka and Snowflake, with experience delivering streaming ingestion, change data capture, data quality, and warehouse transformation. Has improved pipeline reliability and performance, reduced warehouse costs, and mentored data engineering colleagues. AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate.

CORE SKILLS

Data platforms and warehousing: Snowflake, Redshift, AWS EMR, S3, Glue Data Catalog
Programming and processing: Python, SQL, PySpark
Data engineering: Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Airflow, dbt, Snowpipe Streaming
Quality and delivery: Great Expectations, pytest, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Terraform

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. *2022–Present*

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka.
- Designed and built a shipment-event streaming pipeline using partner webhooks, Kafka, Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing around 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling so failed shipment events can be reprocessed without data loss.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium change data capture into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into documented, tested dbt models; introduced incremental models and state:modified CI in GitHub Actions, reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes.
- Reduced monthly Snowflake costs from approximately $38,000 to $24,000 in 2024 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation (one week in six); mentor two mid-level engineers and run data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay *2019–2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing finance's manual month-end reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours.
- Worked on Redshift warehouse design and data quality using Great Expectations.
- Used S3 and the Glue Data Catalog in transaction-reconciliation workflows.

EDUCATION

MSc in Computer Science | Northgate Technical University
Thesis: Incremental materialized views

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate *May 2024*

OPEN-SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an Apache Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests (Python, pytest, 2023).
- Teach introductory SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.